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If California were a nation, it would have been the seventh-ranking economic power in the world. As governor, I discovered a large industrial state like California has many of the same problems and challenges of any industrialized nation: the challenge of keeping our economy strong and modern and our citizens fully employed; the challenge of expanding opportunity for all people; the challenge of helping businesses compete and prosper without over-regulating them; the challenge of helping those who cannot help themselves; the challenge of assuring that every man, woman, and child can go to sleep safe at night and wake up the next day guaranteed the freedom to better their lives.

Even international relations were important to a state like California. We had more imports and exports coming across our borders than any other state—more than many nations—and foreign markets were vital to our prosperity. Fortunately, I had a chance to get a little experience in dealing with foreign leaders that would help me when I got a different job a few years later.

On four occasions when I was governor, President Nixon sent us abroad to represent him on goodwill missions; I carried a personal message from him to foreign leaders but always managed to do a little salesmanship on behalf of California and its business opportunities.

Nancy and I met the heads of state of eighteen countries in Europe and Asia during four overseas trips and had person-to-person experiences we'll never forget.

In Manila, President Ferdinand Marcos and his wife, Imelda, put us up at Malacañang Palace.